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ou will probably not like this introduction to our cover story. If you will still be working at the end of this decade (are not approaching retirement age), or will start working sometime this decade (young adult), you need to pay attention. AI is coming, whether you like it or not, and it will put your job at risk. And you shouldn't be naive enough to think that it will not affect you at all. Whether you run a business, or work in a company that you do not own, AI is just one of multiple factors that will put your livelihood at risk. Most of us will not lose our jobs, but we're going to see increments dry up, while some will even see salaries being cut back. With the costs of living increasing constantly, you're going to need to stay on your toes in order to stay relevant. That's what this cover story is about. First, we're trying to raise the awareness, so that you know where the threat lies. And it's not just AI, but simple churn in the workforce, with more and more young people who are very qualified indeed, entering the workforce, eager to learn. Surplus of options drives down cost, and sadly, our value is only going to go down. Unless, of course, we can help you fix that, by helping you add value, and learn how to make yourself indispensable to just about any company you want to work for. This month, and across many more months, and many more stories to come, we will keep you on the cutting edge of technology, and make sure you're the first to know what it is you need to do in order to become the best version of yourself. Not just you squared, but you cubed!

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SEO UNDERSTANDING

Search Engine Optimisation or SEO understanding is imperative in today's digitally-driven world. It is a concept that has driven an influx of jobs in almost every career vertical. With over a billion websites today, each and every one of those is competing for the coveted spots on search engines such as Google, Bing, Yahoo and more. Why shouldn't they? Ask yourself this question, if you have to look for something as simple as a salon or barber in an area that you aren't too familiar with, the natural first step is to grab your phone and type in "best salons near me" or "barber near me". Google cards whip up multiple suggestions and most people pick between the first five suggestions displayed to them. A whopping 75 per cent of users don't go past the first page of search results. So, as a business, you absolutely want to get featured in those fancied top spots, at least for some of the keywords that people use, if not all of them.

Now, think about large organisations or corporations. They spend exorbitant amounts of money to ensure visibility on search engines since it ultimately drives eyeballs to their website/brand, which generates sales. Having SEO

understanding – knowing and mastering the algorithms behind search engine results – is an indispensable skill that is valued in just about any company on earth! In fact, SEO is still valued higher than digital marketing worldwide, according to Google Trends. There are several career verticals for people with SEO skills to enter, including Search Engine Marketing, Business Marketing Consultant, Digital Marketer, Content Marketer, SEO Manager, SEO Analyst, and the list goes on. In 2017, an approximate boost of 20 per cent was recorded in SEO-based jobs across the globe.

Additionally, SEO jobs are quite future-proof since the amount of computational power it would require for AI to run SEO systems is massive. However, AI is changing how SEO experts do their jobs. Due to developments in AI, Black Hat SEO techniques are being killed off, and content optimisation is what people need to work on, especially for voice search. Plus, images and videos will need to be optimised as well to account for AI ranking sites that do this well. Overall, user experience on websites will be the most important thing, in order to get good rankings in search results, since AI will be able to easily sift through and discard those offerings with less user-friendly options.

AI will also help SEO experts make design decisions based on stats and analytics, and everything will be more data driv-